

clant, picture, 'treasure, teacher.

Words of two syllable with stress on the  
Second syllable

conceal, repent, elector, enough, I'deal, mature, prevent  
undo, physics

Word of three syllable with stress on the <sup>first</sup> second  
Syllable

Confidence, 'photograph, 'holiday, numberless, 'finalist.  
Trinity, simplify, 'tragedy, 'numerous, Hospital

Words of three syllable with stress on the  
Second syllable

Sectionar, official, offence, quotation, to'bacco, out-  
standing, interpret, develop, Im'portant.

Words of three syllable with stress on the third  
Syllable

Referee, magazine, Compre'hend, decompos, Confident,  
discontent, inter'rupt, inter'pose, Im'pact.

Why mono-syllabic words are stressed when  
pronounced in isolation words of two or more syll-  
ables have a stress pattern which is unpredictable  
there are however, few clues to note about the  
stress position of words.

## Stress

Stress means force, pressure or extra weight added to in pronouncing a particular syllable in a word. It is also the emphasis placed on a sound or syllable by pronouncing it more loudly and forcefully than those surrounding it in word or phrase syllables which are uttered with great muscular energy are said to be stressed while those produced with less effort are said to be unstressed. Stress is indicated by the use of a slight vertical stroke (|) at the beginning of the stressed syllable. Word stress occurs at the primary and secondary levels. The primary stress is the strongest force exerted on a syllable in a word while in secondary stress, two syllables are stressed though not to the same degree or force.

### Words of one syllable

This is also referred to as monosyllable. Examples come, go, stand, seat, cat, run, buy, up, down, clap, laugh, dance etc.

### Words of two syllable with stress on the first

syllable - It is also known as disyllable. Example wonder, number, extra, baker, London, morning, me